

38.2 INDIRECT CLOSED QUESTIONS

Indirect closed questions are formed using "if" or "whether."
In this context, "if" and "whether" mean the same thing.



Could you tell me { if whether } it is raining outside?

Polite opening phrase

The subject comes before the verb.

Is it raining outside?



FURTHER EXAMPLES



Do you know if that restaurant is expensive?



Could you tell me whether the train is on time?

HOW TO FORM

OPENING PHRASE

"IF / WHETHER"

SUBJECT

VERB

REST OF SENTENCE

Do you know

if

it

is

raining outside?

A polite opening phrase comes first.



COMMON MISTAKES WORD ORDER WITH INDIRECT QUESTIONS

When a question has an opening phrase, the word order in indirect questions is the same as in a statement. There is no inversion, and "do" is not added.

Could you tell me where the station is? ✓

Could you tell me where is the station? ✗

Could you tell me when you close? ✓

Could you tell me when do you close? ✗